



Silifarm Team (L to R): Roni Mondal, CEO, Co-founder; Rohan Roy, COO, Co-founder; and Amit Dutta, CTO



A model demonstrating use of Matri

2020, the founders Roy and Mondal were working on their first, yet-to-be-launched product Matri since 2018. After improving the prototype over 12 times, it is now ready to be launched in the market in the coming months.

It is noteworthy that the start-up—working with silicon at its heart—was incubated at IIT Patna,

which is providing it with much-needed infrastructural and financial support. The company has tested the product with more than 400 volunteers. Mondal says, “We received 94 per cent positive feedback.”

Coming to biology, it is inherent that the tissue structure and fat thickness vary in different parts of our body. In women’s lower abdomen, it is quite different due to the presence of the uterus.

Roy explains, “Matri generates a particular pattern of pulse that we have designed specifically for menstrual pain. Through the strings that attach to the body, the pulse travels and penetrates the skin.” It must be noted that two self-adhesive electrode gel pads stick to the lower abdomen to relieve the pain.

Mondal points out, “Pain is a signal that travels through the nerve to the brain. Matri blocks the pain pathway; thus, the pain signal doesn’t reach the brain.” A tucking hook is provided at the back of this device for easy wearability.

The device is expected to cost around ₹1,500, including two pairs

of gel pads. The founders stress the high affordability of Matri in comparison to its competitors like Welme and Livia, thereby incentivising the common womanhood in Indian society. They claim that Matri provides relief within 10-15 minutes of usage.

Busy making the prototypes during college days, the boys faced the essential examination pressure. And after graduating, the employment pressure loomed large. But the founders believed that everything could be compromised on the path of entrepreneurship and refused to take up the college placement offer.

With no female teammates initially, they made the product on their own and tested it on their family members. After receiving the green signal, they took it to their friends and associates, who cooperated enough to give wings to their entrepreneurship.

Now, as the startup is gearing up to launch the product by March 2023, the team has onboarded an AIIMS gynaecologist as a medical mentor, an R&D engineer, and some interns.

By January end, Silifarm is expecting a good amount of funding from the Technology Development Board (TDB) under the Department of Science and Technology, government of India. It will boost its plan to move forth in the medical device sector, especially in the women’s health and hygiene domain, and expand the team with skilled (not necessarily qualified) individuals.

—Vaishali Yadav

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AI POWERED SENSOR NODES FOR SUSTAINABLE FUTURE

Bert Labs is a Bengaluru based deep tech startup that is working towards sustainable energy incorporating AI powered IoT and AI to improve energy efficiency in industrial and commercial setups. The company designs and develops its sensor nodes and the whole ecosystem to sense energy consumption, compute the data, and take necessary action to save energy consumption in a building